



Rep. Tom Emmer on The Scott Jennings Podcast

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SCOTT JENNINGS:

and all of the day's news is the whip of the House Majority Republican Conference, Tom Emmer of Minnesota. Mr. Emmer, thanks for coming back on the Scott Jennings Show. You heard Secretary Hegseth. You've been watching and getting briefings from the administration about the war effort. What's your reaction so far? How we doing?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, God bless Donald Trump for being a decision maker and a leader. He is the ultimate negotiator and the ultimate peacemaker. He negotiates and he draws the the line, unlike previous presidents who would point out this is a red line and don't enforce it. And let's face it, Scott, he's doing a job that a Democrat by the name of Jimmy Carter should have done some 40 to 50 years ago. When this happened, it never had to get this to this level had Jimmy Carter just been willing to do his job. Donald Trump is now cleaning that up for former President Carter and all those that followed him because this is the chief sponsor of terror. They are committed and they have been since 1979 to destroying the United States of America. And for anyone, especially the the minority leader, and there's a reason why he's going to remain in the minority, Hakeem Jeffries to come out on the news the day after the strike and say we're gonna lose. I mean, come on, Hakeem. At some point we got to be Americans, right? At some point we've got to recognize that we have young men and women wearing the uniform. Their families are here at home praying for them every day. We need to support them. And Hakeem and Democrats need to understand, not only was this mission necessary because of an imminent threat that it posed to the American, the U.S. homeland, but these young men and women, we got to support them, Scott.

SCOTT JENNINGS:

Do you get the feeling that there are elements of the Democratic Party and elements of our media that are rooting for American failure, all because they would like to see something politically bad happen to Donald Trump?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, I mean, it's not a feeling. That is absolutely a fact. It starts with their Trump derangement syndrome, but it's bigger than that. I mean, this is a cancer that has been growing in this country for several years. Some would argue for probably the same amount of time as the Ayatollah has been waging war against us. We have a war internally that seeks to be anti-American, seeks to change everything that our founders held good and great and, you know, to undo what the greatest generation did during World War II. This has been ongoing. And by the way, it's not the majority of the country, but they sound like they're the majority because of the left-wing anti-American media that promotes them. And they want to give people the feeling that they are the majority. They want to try to browbeat people and, I think, scare people into believing, well, you need to see it this way. I think the majority of Americans are patriotic. They understand the threat posed by Iran. And they certainly understand that when we're at war, we have kids, troops, heroes in theater. We have to support those people.



And the idea that you would go out and give off even the vibe that you hope for American failure to me, well, look, at the State of the Union, the president asked the Democrats to stand up and affirm that their highest duty is to protect the American people. And not a single one of them could bring themselves to do it. That emotion seems to be extending to the war effort.

SCOTT JENNINGS:

Let's talk a little bit about the midterm elections. It's a closely divided House, narrow Republican majority. You're the whip, which means you've got to keep the conference together, which I know is difficult sometimes. But as you look ahead to the November elections, what are the issues that stand out to you that Republicans need to run on in order to retain this majority and frankly outkick our historical coverage? Midterms often go against the party in power.

REP. TOM EMMER:

That's true, but we've never had a map like this. I think people forget that in 2018, Trump's first midterm, where he was not quite as interested in that as he is in this one, which we can talk about because that's another factor that's going to play. In that midterm, Scott, we were defending over 20 of our members who were in seats that Hillary Clinton had won in the 2016 election. And in spite of that, I would argue this is the other problem, is we ran on the wrong message back then. It was one message. We're 435 pieces of ground. You've heard the Speaker talk about this is likely going to come down to 31 seats in the House to determine this. Those seats, each one has a unique geography with its own demographic. We do not drive the national message out of the House. We are impacted by it. We can be from the main speaker, which is Donald J. Trump, or things that happen. But our candidates, our incumbents, are the product that we are offering. They need to look and sound like the districts they're running in. This is what we started back in the 2020 cycle. And they need to market that district based on the issue that's most important. You might remember back in 2020 when they said we were gonna lose 24 seats in that election. We actually beat 12 Democrats that night and almost took back the majority for the first time in almost 52 years, I think it was, during a presidential cycle. It was, you know, you ran on energy in Oklahoma City. You ran on socialism as a bad thing in southern, in Miami, South Miami. We were successful because we were doing, we were selling exactly what is most important. This cycle, it's gonna be what it is every time. There will be nuances, but sometime after Labor Day this year, the vast majority of the public that decides these elections, that they don't wear a partisan Republican or partisan Democrat jersey year-round like we do, right? They'll wake up and they'll say, oh, we got an election. You know what they'll do? It will be an emotional experience where they'll ask themselves, do I feel better today than I did under the last administration? And do I see a bright future for myself and my kids economically, prosperous? If the answer to those questions is yes, we're gonna stay in the majority. And I believe it's going to be yes because of the big beautiful bill.

SCOTT JENNINGS:

The president, of course, is going to be a big part of the Republican messaging operation. We were chatting before we went on the air. It seems like your governor in Minnesota, Tim Walz, has announced he's going to travel the country on behalf of Democrats.

REP. TOM EMMER:

All I can say is this is a positive development.

SCOTT JENNINGS:

Tom Emmer for Minnesota. Thanks for coming by the show.



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